

Notice of Intent: Vitrobot Vitrification Robot and Clipping Accessories

(75N98026Q00200)

The National Institutes of Health intends to award a Firm-Fixed-Price Purchase Order to FEI Company.

In accordance with FAR Part 6.302-1, FEI Company is the only known responsible source who can provide the products/services that meet our standards. No other source has been identified who can provide the requirements listed below.

This order is to purchase a Thermo Fisher Scientific Vitrobot vitrification system and associated accessories, for the Laboratory of Molecular Biology (LMB) to conduct structural biology research on Ribonucleic Acid (RNA), ribonucleoprotein complexes, and protein–RNA interactions relevant to human health and disease.

The Vitrobot vitrification system provides automated and reproducible preparation of cryo-EM grids by precisely controlling environmental parameters such as humidity, temperature, blotting force, blotting time, and plunge timing during vitrification. The instrument enables consistent preparation of high-quality cryo-EM specimens necessary for structural studies performed on cryo-electron microscopes within the NIH cryo-EM facilities.

The requested purchase also includes specialized accessories required for cryo-EM grid preparation workflows, including grid assembly tools and cryo-EM grid handling equipment required for compatibility with automated cryo-electron microscope autoloader systems.

This notice is not a request for competitive quotes. FEI Company is the manufacturer. However, any available small businesses (e.g., 8(a), service-disabled veteran owned small business, HUBZone small business, small disadvantaged business, veteran-owned small business, and women-owned small business) as stated herein may submit a written capability statement that clearly supports and demonstrates their ability to perform the requirement. A determination by the Government to compete this proposed award based upon responses to this notice is solely within the discretion of the Government.

It is anticipated that an award will be issued approximately five (5) days after the date of this notice unless the Government determines that another vendor has the capability to meet this requirement.

Please email responses to david.shen@nih.gov no later than 7:00 a.m. EDT on April 23, 2026.